JobDesk CRM

User Manual and Feature Guide — version 3.5.4

The CRM for recruiters built to work offline, with no monthly subscription.

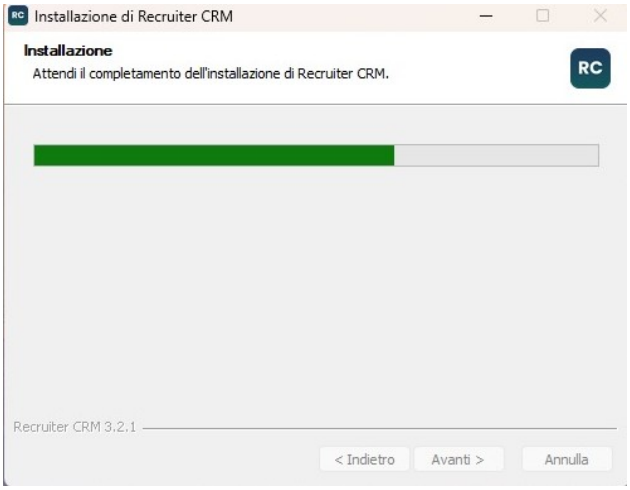
What is JobDesk CRM

JobDesk CRM is a Windows program built for people who handle recruiting and hiring: it manages a candidate's entire journey, from first contact to hire, with no monthly subscription and no need for a constant internet connection. All your data stays on your own PC. (If you still see the name “Recruiter CRM” in the installer file, it is the same program: it has simply been renamed.)

It includes: candidate records with a customizable pipeline, Kanban view, callbacks with reminders, resume upload with automatic data and skill detection, a job match that finds the best-fitting candidates for a position, free-form worksheets with data validation (like Excel), charts, ready-made email templates — including a generator for interview invitations with a clickable meeting link — automatic backups, and updates that download themselves.

Installation

1. Get the installer file (e.g. **Recruiter-CRM-Setup.exe**)
2. Double-click it to start

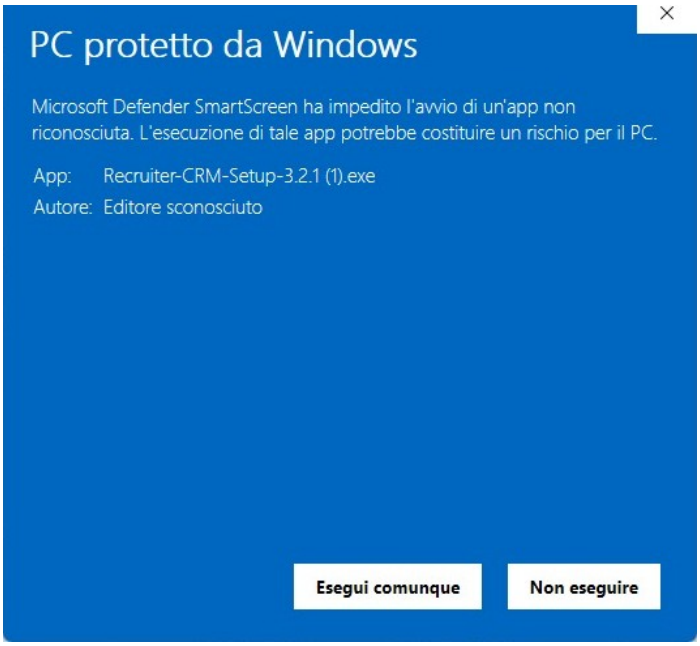


installer window

The Windows blue screen — it's normal, here's what to do

The first time you run the installer, Windows may show a blue screen saying “Windows protected your PC” or “Unknown publisher”. This isn't a virus: it happens because the program doesn't (yet) have a paid digital signature issued by Microsoft — an expensive process that affects many legitimate small-business programs too.

To continue: click “More info”, then the “Run anyway” button that appears right below it. This step is only needed the first time.

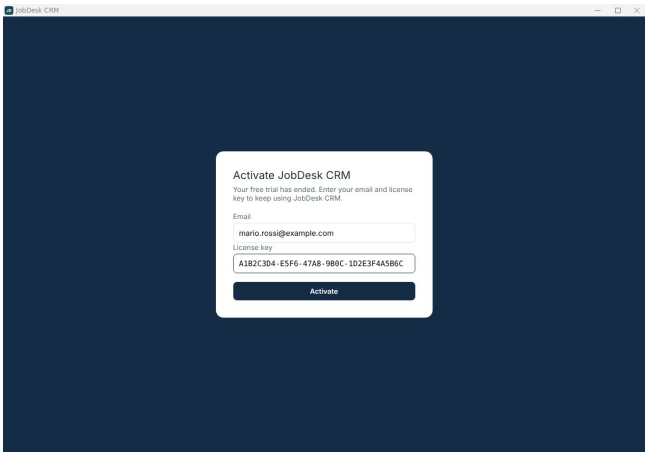


Windows SmartScreen blue screen

3. Follow the installer (you can choose where to install it, or keep the default)
4. Once done, you'll find the icon on the Desktop and in the Start menu

Free trial and activation

The program can be tried for free for 14 days from first launch. A banner at the top reminds you how much of the trial is left. Once it ends, you'll be asked for the license key you received after purchase. At any time, from the “License” item in the side menu, you can see whether the license is active (with activation date and the last characters of the key) or how many trial days are left.

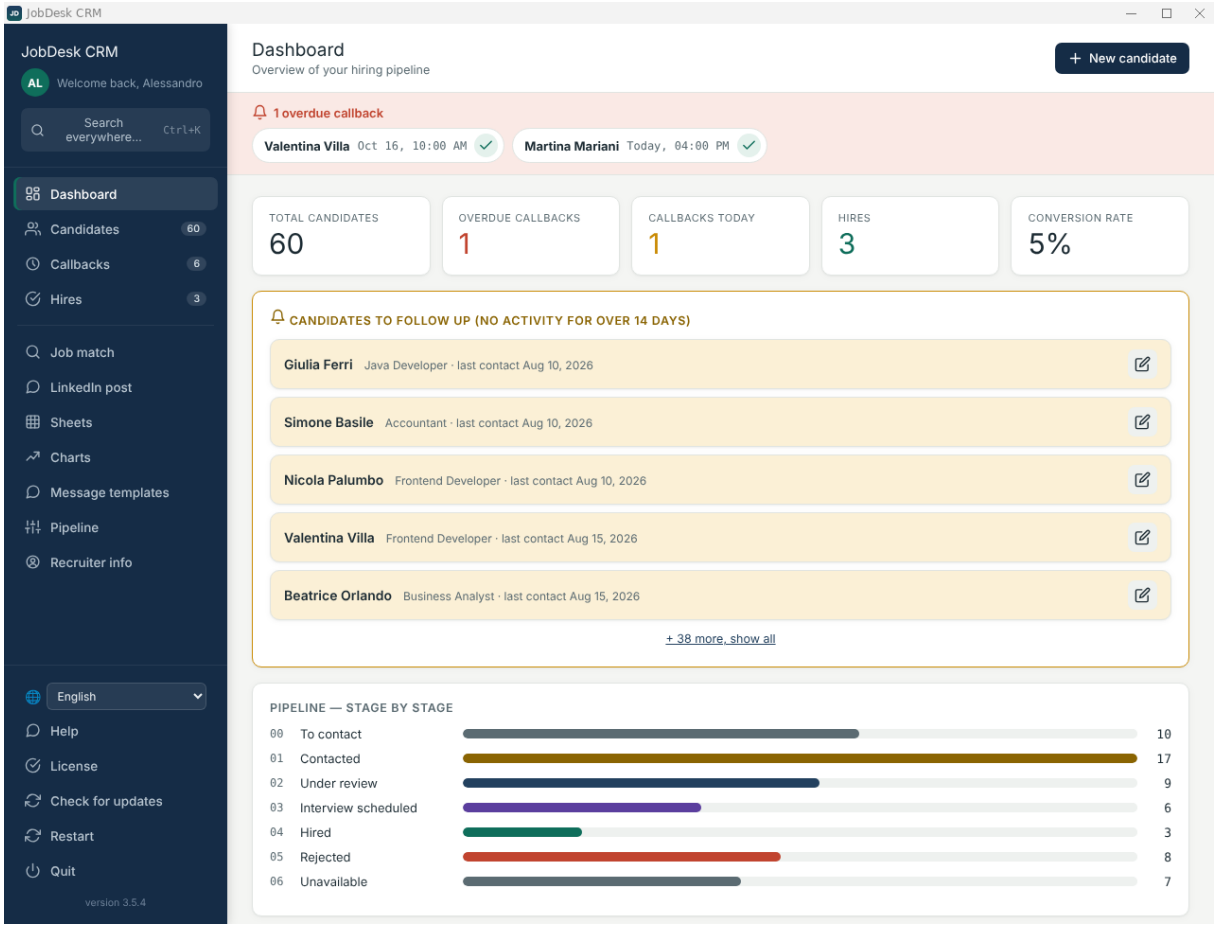


license activation screen

The very first time you open it, before anything else, it's worth going to the **Recruiter info** section and filling in your name, email, phone, company and locations: this information is then used automatically to sign the messages the program generates.

The sections of the program

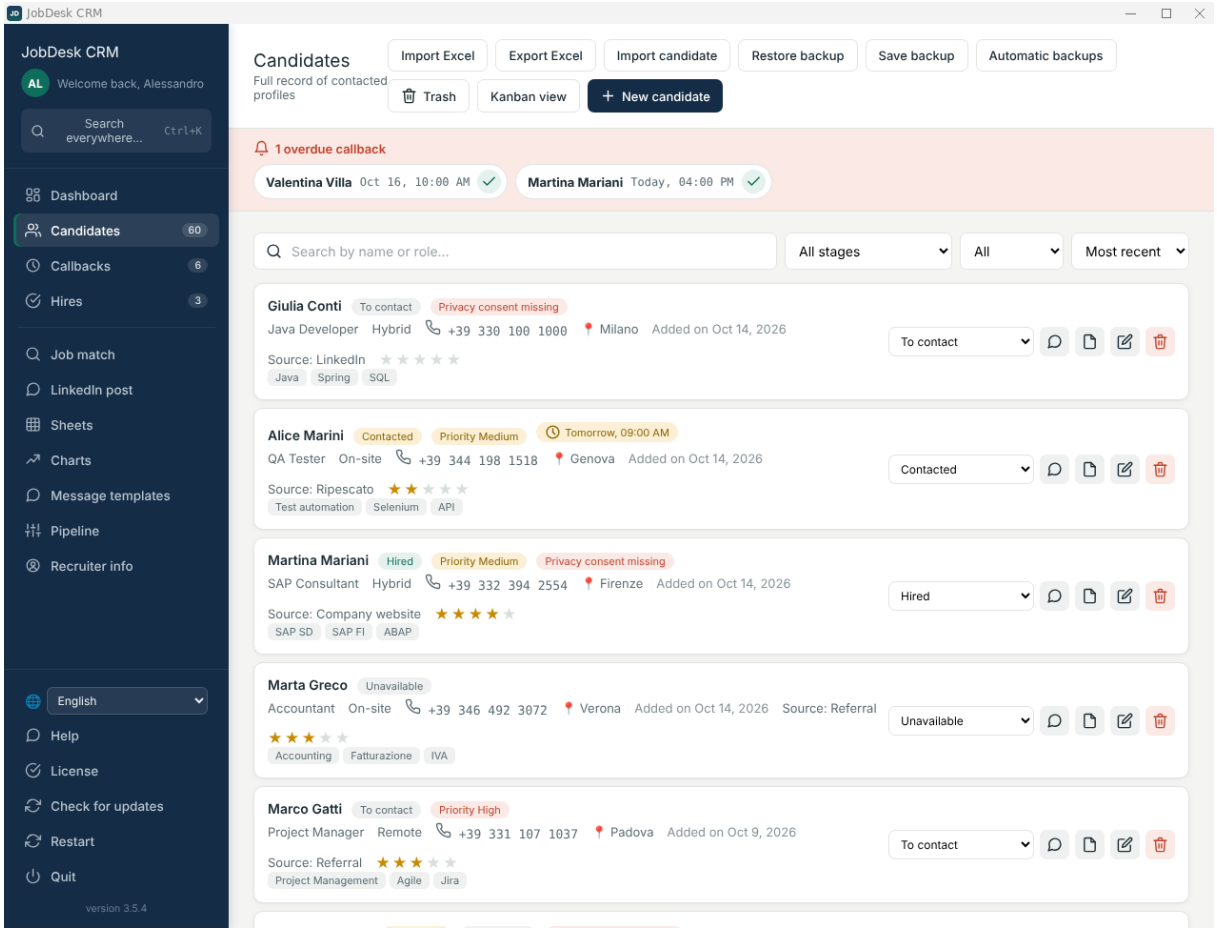
Dashboard



Dashboard section

- Overview at a glance: total candidates, overdue or today's callbacks, hires, conversion rate.
- An alert flags candidates with no activity for over 14 days — click it to see and open them all.
- A bar chart shows how many candidates are in each pipeline stage.

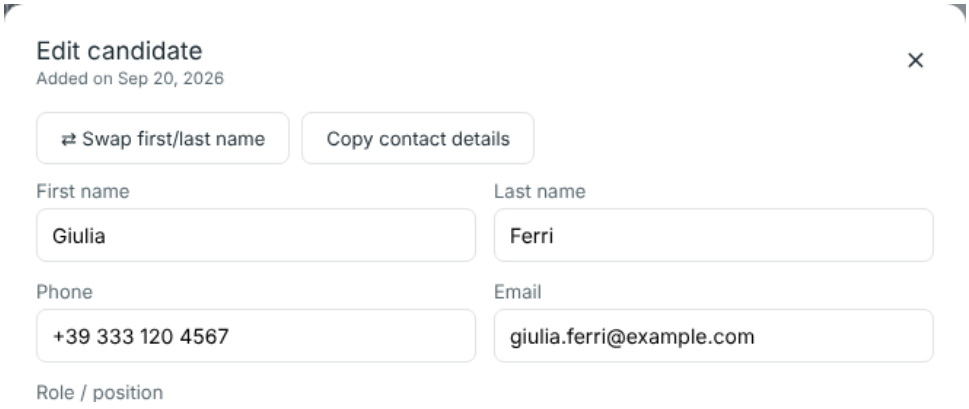
Candidates



Candidates section

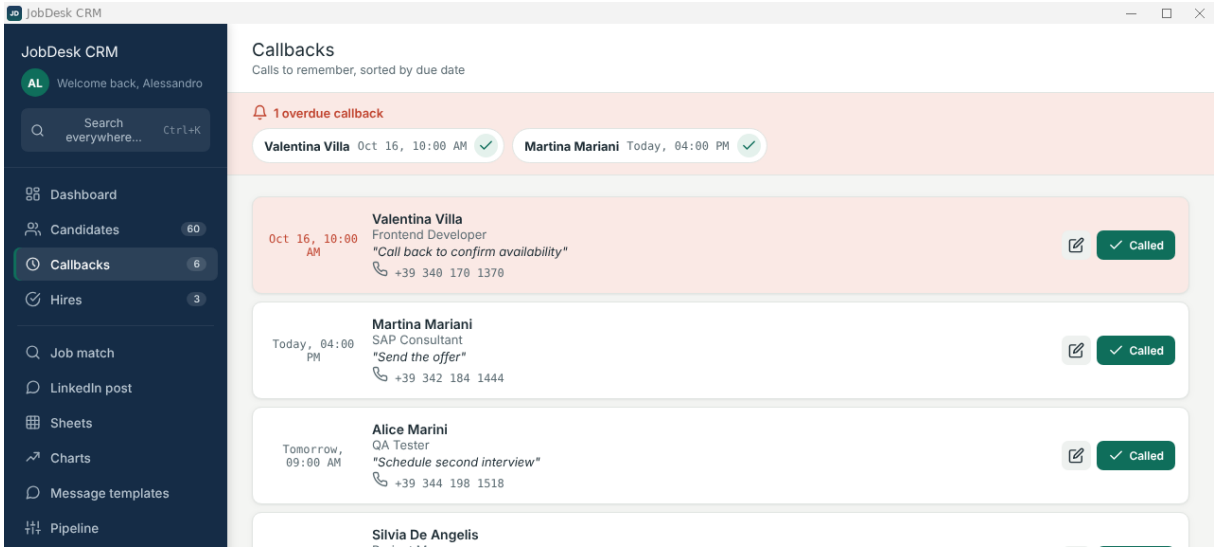
- Full profile: first and last name, phone, email, city, role, availability (Full onsite / Hybrid / Remote).
- Customizable pipeline stage, candidate source, client company (for agency recruiters), star rating, free-form colored tags.
- List or Kanban view, draggable from one stage to another.
- **Kanban view** with an always-visible horizontal scrollbar, and scrolling with the keyboard arrow keys when the view is selected.
- Resume upload (PDF or Word) with **automatic filling**: from the resume the program recognises first name, last name, phone, email, city, role and skills, and pre-fills the empty fields of the record (fields you already filled are never overwritten). Since resumes are not all alike, always check the data before saving.
- **Swap first/last name**: if the first and last name came out reversed from the resume, one click on the button swaps them.
- **Copy contact details**: copies first and last name, city, phone and email in one go — one per line, with a blank line between them and skipping empty fields — ready to paste into an email, a message or another program.
- **Second resume (anonymized version)**: you can also attach a second version of the resume with the candidate's personal details removed, to use when presenting them to a client.

- A free-notes section always at hand, and an activity history dated for every call or update.
- GDPR privacy consent, with a reminder if it's missing.
- **Export to Excel with chosen candidates**: in the export window you can choose “Pick candidates”, search by name and tick only the ones you need, with the “Select all” and “None” buttons.
- Trash: deleted candidates can be restored for 30 days before being permanently removed.
- Excel import and export, filterable by month or year added.
- **Export candidate / Import candidate**: the Export candidate button saves a candidate's entire profile — resumes included — as a separate file, handy for emailing to a colleague who uses the same program. They can then load it back in with the Import candidate button, with no need to re-type anything.



the two buttons at the top of the candidate record

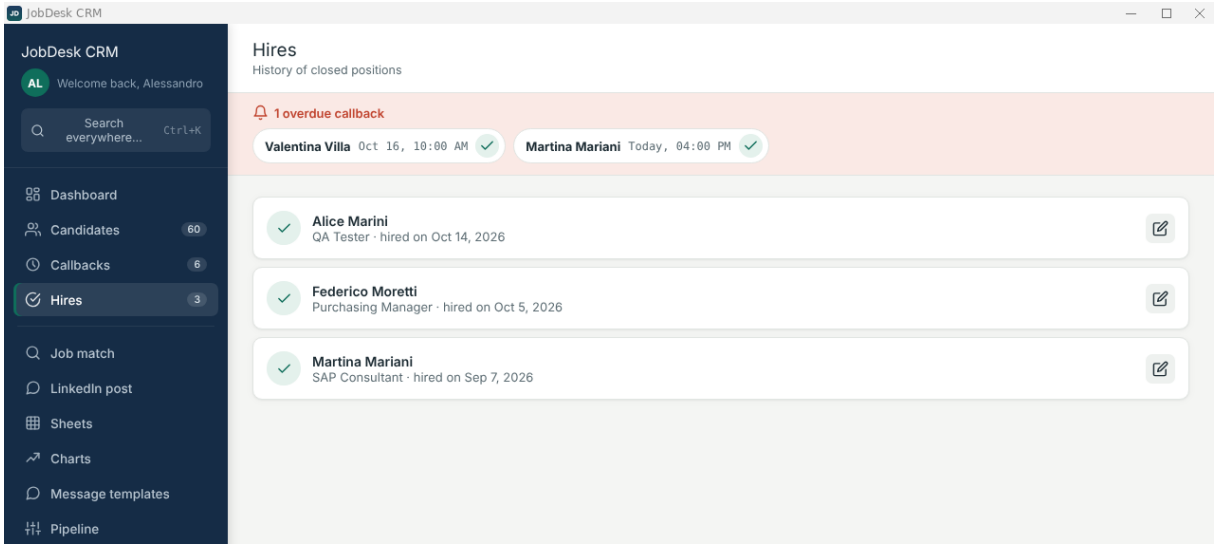
Callbacks



Callbacks section

- A list of calls to make, sorted by due date, with a Windows notification when it's time.

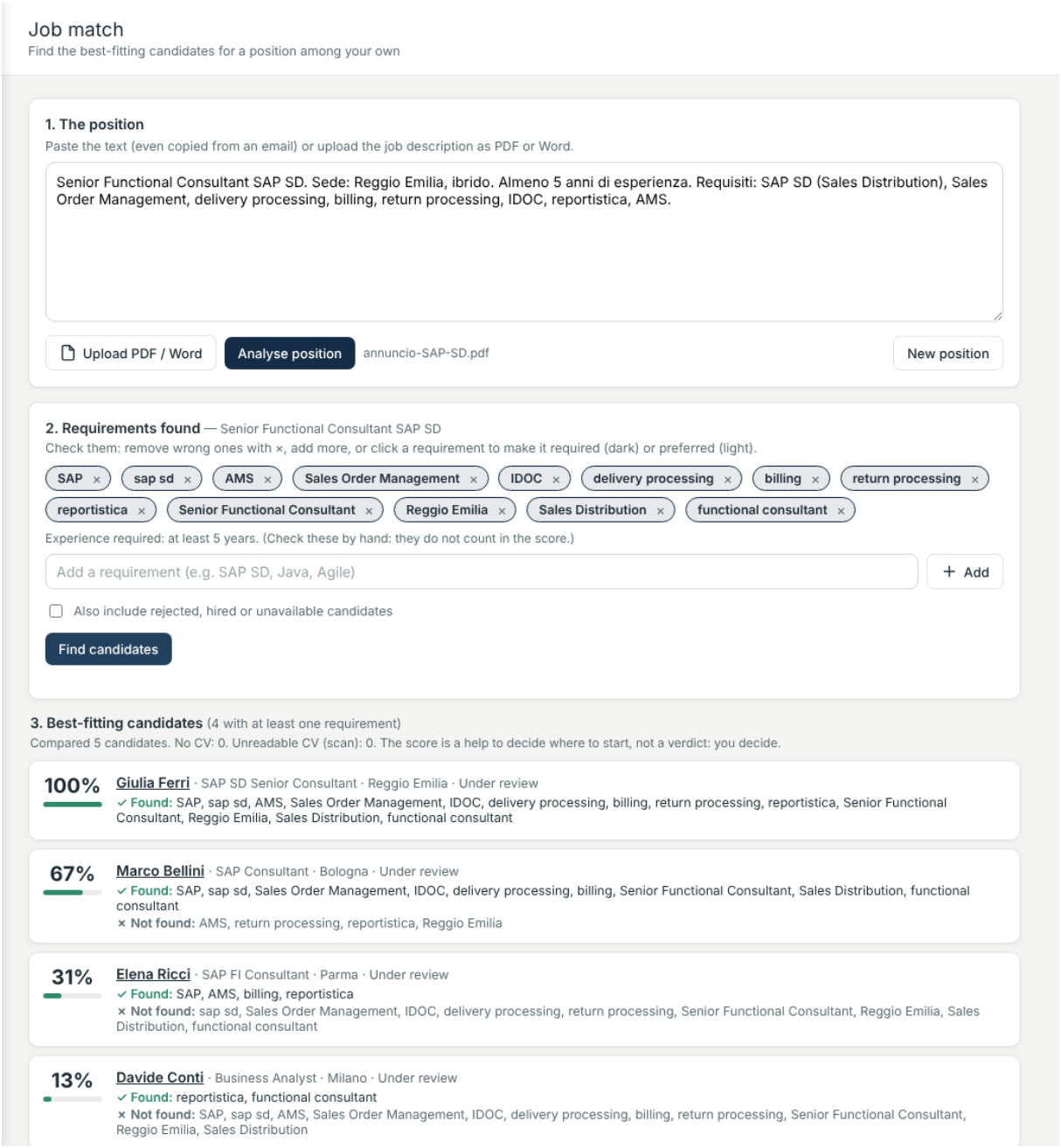
Hires



Hires section

- A history of every position successfully closed.

Job match



Job match section (sample candidates)

- Use it to find, among the candidates you already have, the best fit for a new open position (for example “SAP SD” or “PMO”).
- **1. The position**: paste the job description text (even copied from an email) or upload the PDF or Word file, then press “Analyse position”.
- **2. Requirements found**: the program extracts the main requirements by itself and shows them as tags. Remove wrong ones with the ×, add your own, or click a requirement to make it required (dark) or preferred (light).
- **3. Best-fitting candidates**: press “Find candidates”. You get a ranking with a percentage, the requirements found and the missing ones; click a name to open the candidate record.

• By default rejected, hired and unavailable candidates are excluded; tick the box to include them.

• Everything happens on your PC, with no online artificial intelligence and without changing any candidate data. The first time the program reads the resumes (it may take a moment), then it remembers them and later comparisons are fast.

• Candidates with no resume, or with an unreadable one (for example a scan), are scored on role, skills and notes.

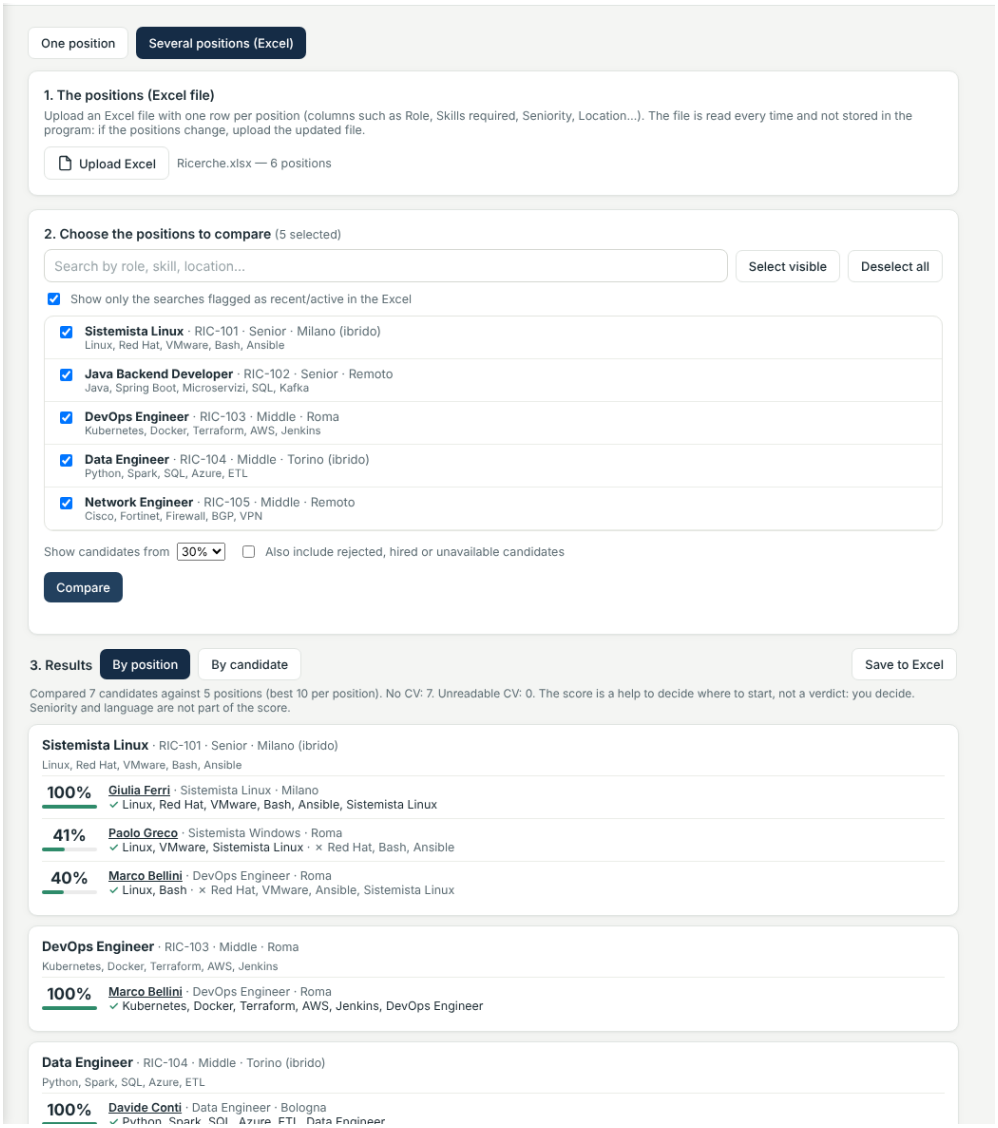
• The percentage is an aid to decide where to start, not a verdict: the decision is yours. Required experience (e.g. “at least 5 years”) is shown but must be checked by hand.

• **Several positions from an Excel file**: at the top of this section, the “Several positions (Excel)” button lets you compare your candidates with many positions at once. Upload the file (one row per position, with columns such as Role, Skills required, Seniority, Location and, if you like, a column flagging recent searches), choose the positions — by default the ones flagged as recent — and press “Compare”.

• The file is read every time and is not stored in the program: if the positions change, upload the updated file. For good results write precise terms in the skills column, separated by commas (e.g. “Red Hat, WebSphere Liberty, SSL/TLS”).

• **By position**: for each position the 10 best candidates, with requirements found and missing. **By candidate**: for each candidate the positions where they may fit (with “+ more positions” to see them all). “Save to Excel” exports the result.

• A skill mentioned only once in a long resume weighs less than one mentioned several times. If the candidate's role is of a different type than the position (for example a developer on a systems-administrator position), the score does not go above 70% and a “Score capped” note appears.

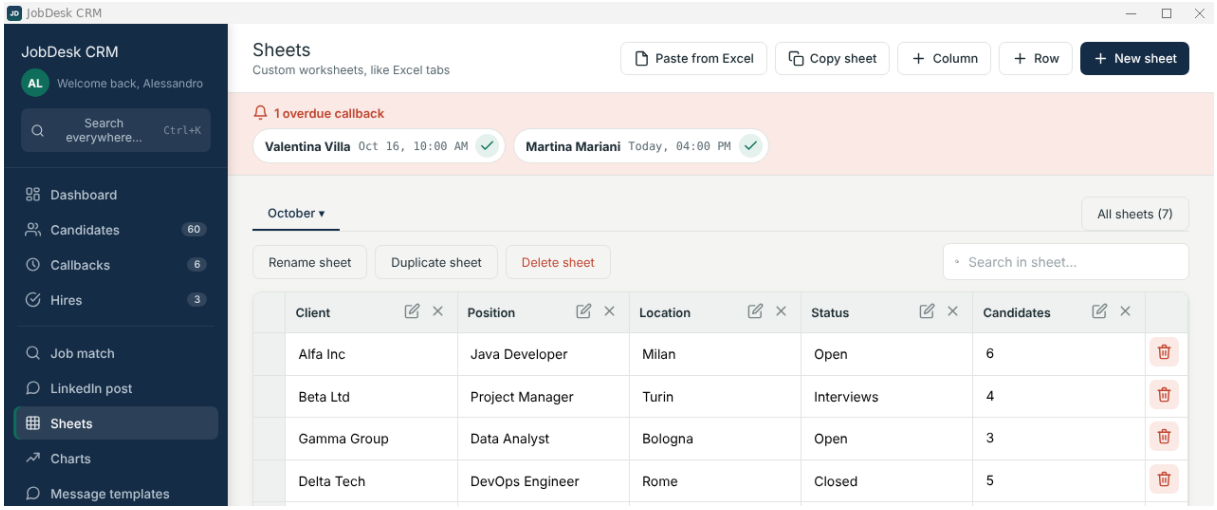


Job match with several positions from Excel (sample positions and candidates)



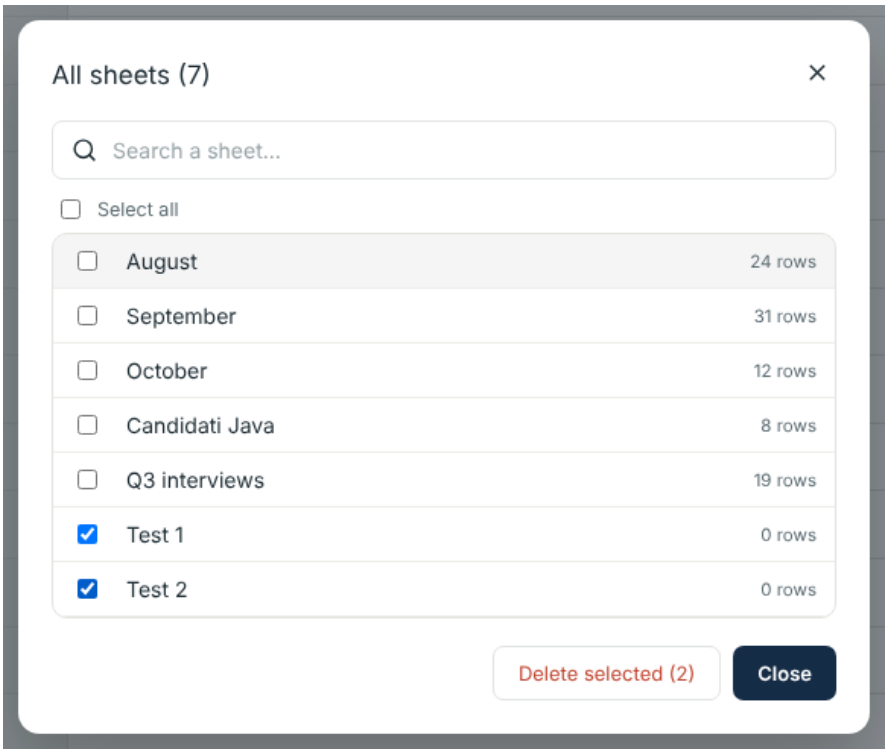
“By candidate” view

Sheets



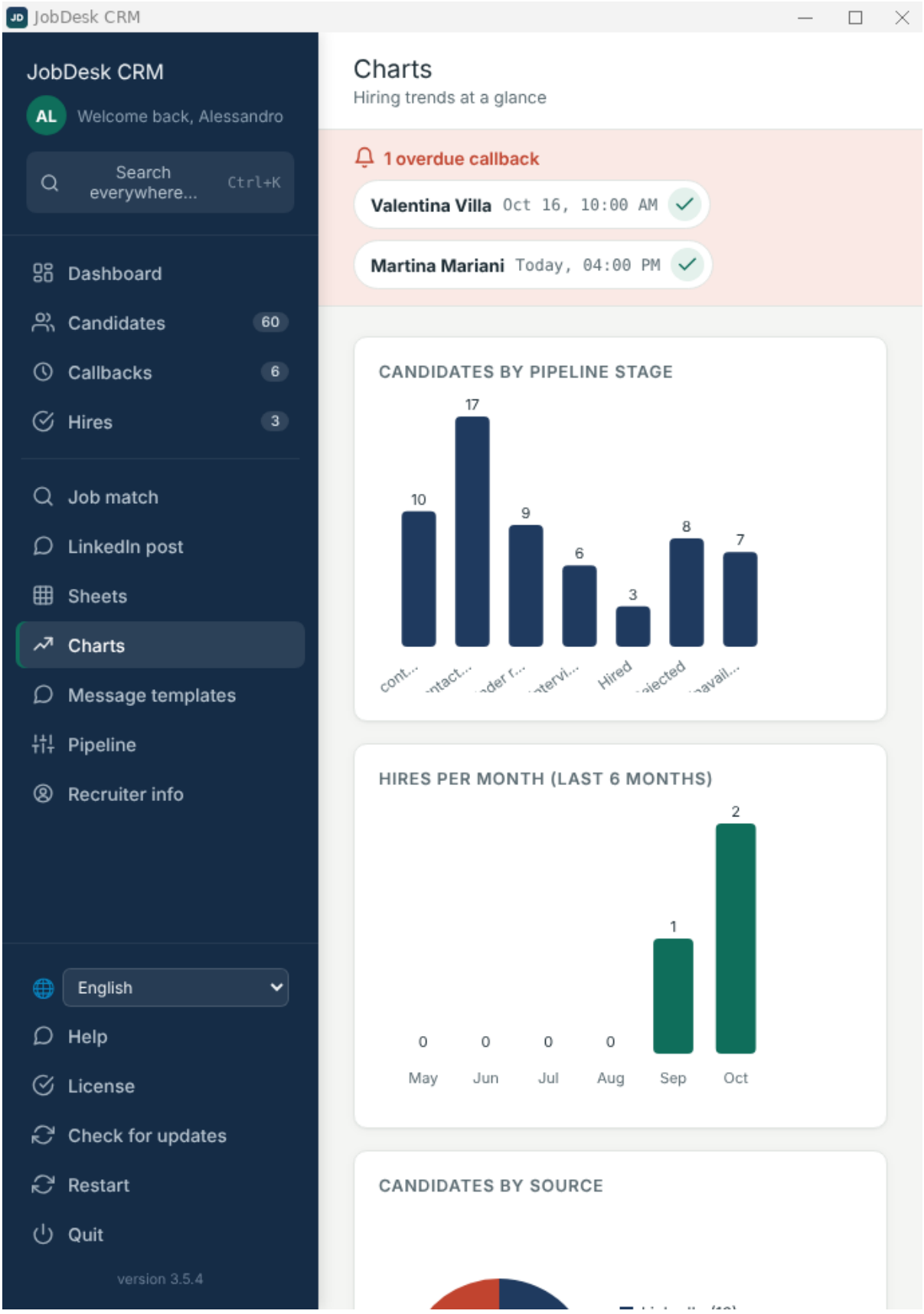
Sheets section

- Free-form, Excel-style worksheets: create a sheet (e.g. “August”), choose how many columns, and give each one a type (Text, Number, Date, or Choice from a list with data validation — exactly like Excel).
- Conditional colors on choice columns, customizable alignment and text wrapping, columns and rows resizable by dragging, just like Excel.
- Real copy/paste with Excel in both directions.
- **Recent-sheets bar** and “All sheets” button: they open the full list, searchable by name, so you no longer scroll through dozens of tabs.
- **Multiple delete**: in the list tick several sheets (or “Select all”) and press “Delete selected”, after a confirmation. Before deleting, the program automatically saves a safety copy of your sheets (the last 15 are kept).



“All sheets” list with multiple selection

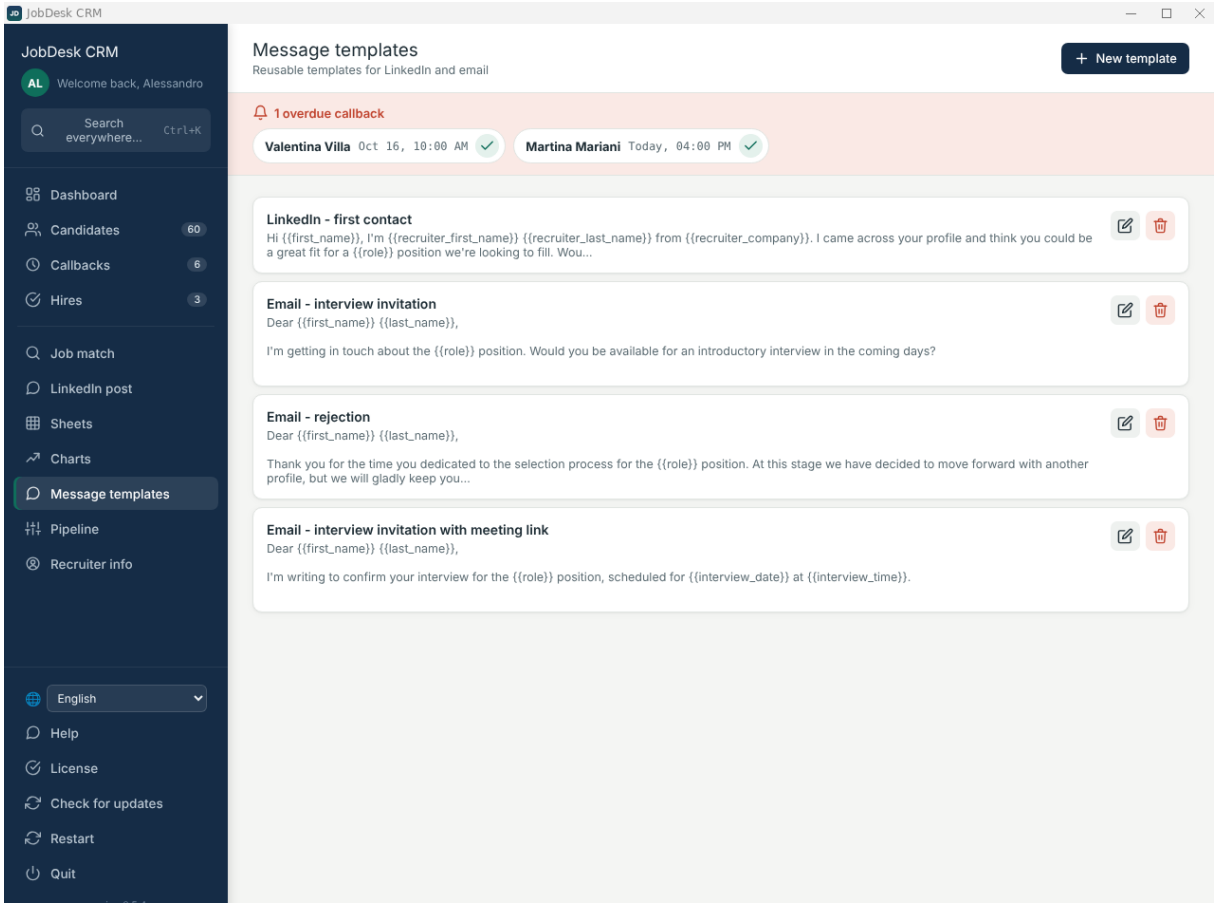
Charts



Charts section

- Candidates by stage, hires per month, and distribution by source — generated automatically from your data.

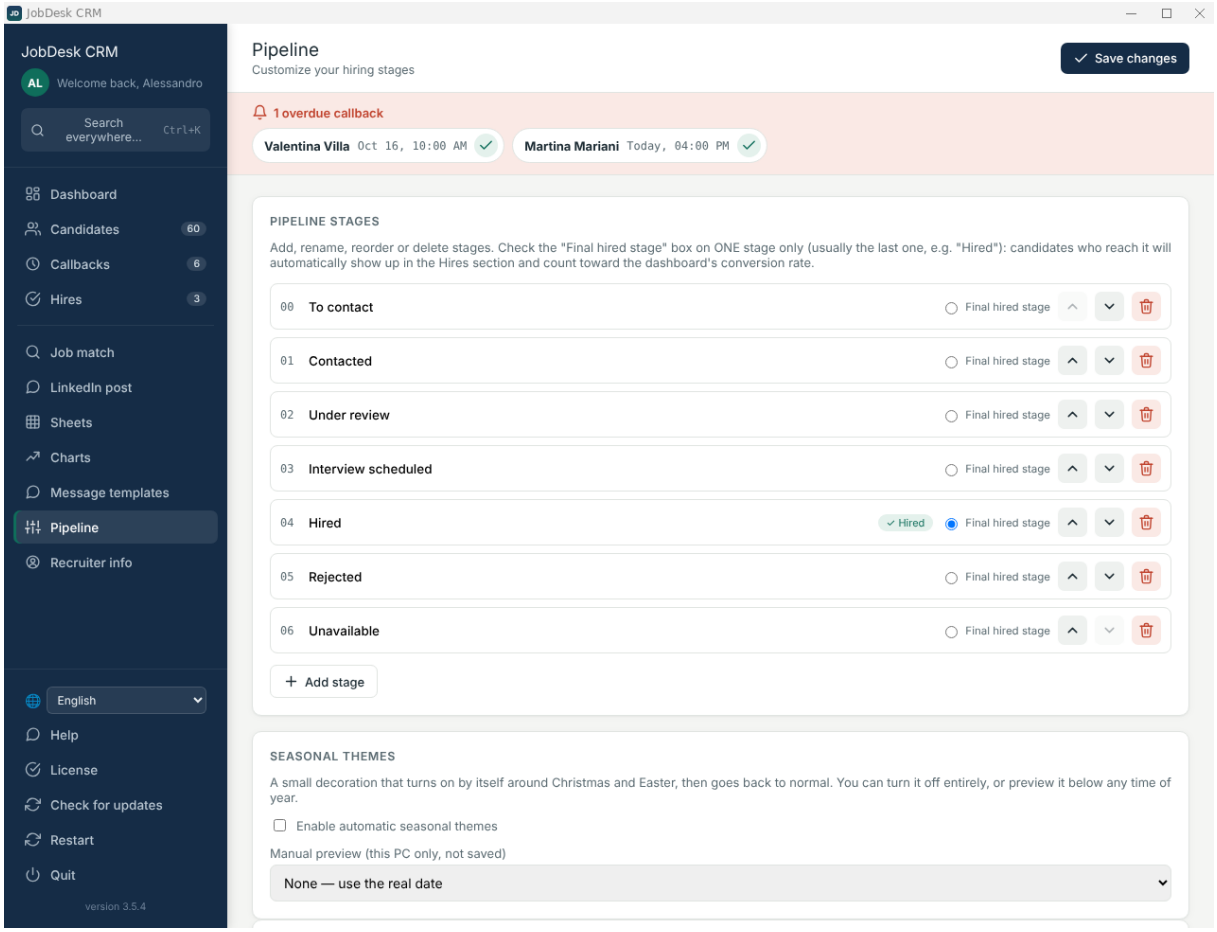
Message templates



Message templates section

- Ready-made message templates (LinkedIn, email) that fill themselves in with the candidate's data and your own recruiter details.
- An interview-invite generator: enter the date, time, meeting link (Teams, Zoom, Meet) and notes — the program prepares the text, with the link staying clickable when pasted into Outlook or Gmail.

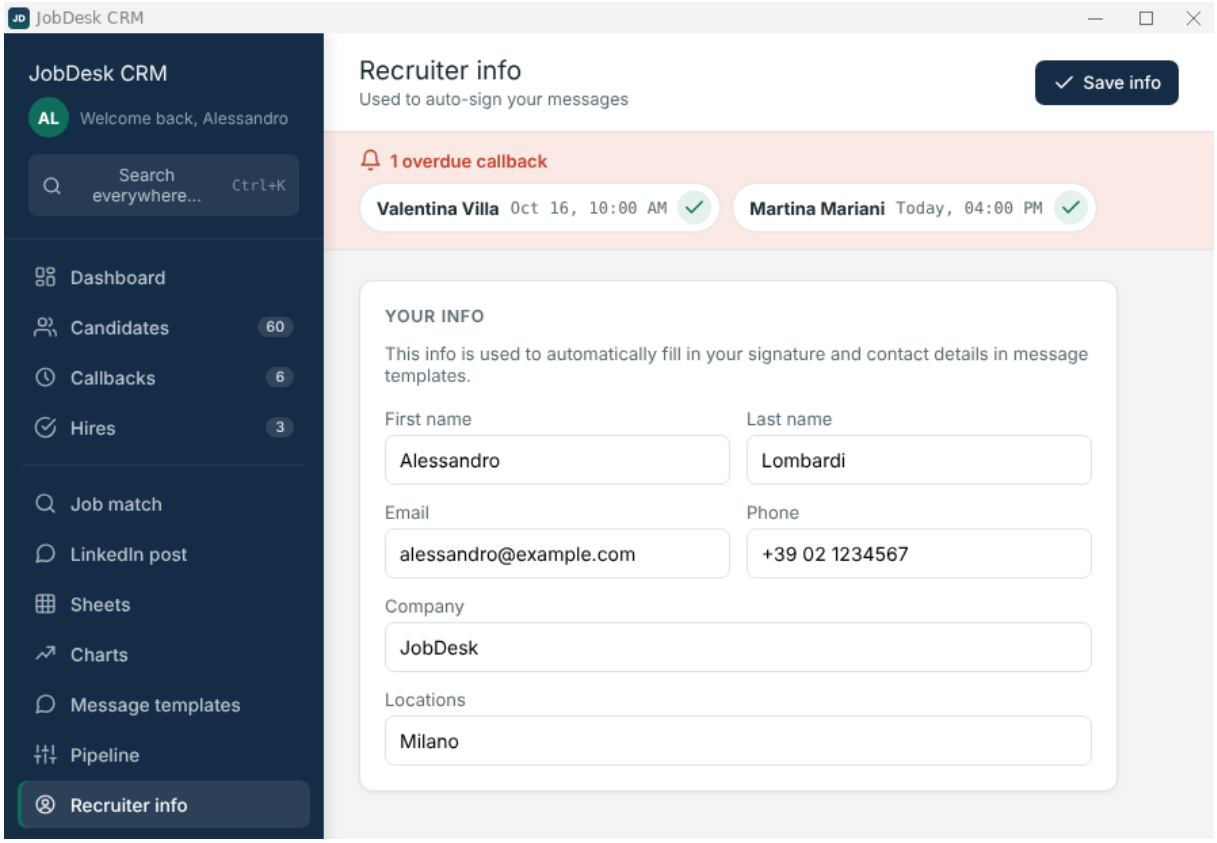
Pipeline



Pipeline section

- Hiring stages are fully customizable: add, rename, reorder or delete stages, no technical setup needed.
- The list of candidate sources is customizable too.
- Optional seasonal themes (a small decoration at Christmas and Easter, can be turned off).

Recruiter info



Recruiter info section

- Your own contact details, used to automatically sign the messages the program generates.

What's new in the latest versions at a glance

- The program is now called **JobDesk CRM**, like the jobdeskcrm.com website. The installer file and installation window still show the name “Recruiter CRM”: it is the same program, and your data does not change.
- Two new items in the side menu: **Help** (opens the manual, guides and demo on the website) and **License** (shows whether the license is active or how many trial days are left).
- **Export to Excel** with a choice of which candidates to include.
- More convenient **Kanban view**: always-visible scrollbar and keyboard navigation.
- Automatic data filling from the resume, with “Swap first/last name” and “Copy contact details” buttons.
- New **Job match** section to find the best-fitting candidates for a job description, also with **several positions from an Excel file** and a more accurate score.
- More convenient Sheets: recent-sheets bar, full searchable list, deleting several sheets at once, and automatic backup.
- Fully English interface: default stages, sources and skills are translated (ones you renamed stay as you wrote them) and an English set of templates is available.

- Even better data protection: safe saving, and automatic restore from a valid backup if a file turns out to be damaged.

Your data is always safe

Candidates, sheets and settings don't live inside the program itself: they live in a separate folder on your PC. Uninstalling or updating the program never touches it.

On top of that, the program automatically keeps safety copies (at most one every 6 hours, keeping the latest 30), available any time from the “Automatic backups” button in the Candidates section. You can also save or restore a backup manually whenever you like. Saving is “atomic”: a sudden interruption (power cut, forced close) can never leave a half-written file. If a data file turns out to be damaged, the program keeps it aside and automatically restores the latest valid backup. If you are about to save an empty list over a full one, an immediate backup is made first.

Automatic updates

When a new version is released, the program lets you know on its own (or you can click “Check for updates” in the side menu) and offers to download and install it — just like Slack or Discord do — without ever touching the data you've already entered.

App language

At the bottom left of the side menu you can switch the interface language between Italian and English at any time, with no restart needed. Everything is translated: menus, records, messages, dates, and the default stages and sources. Below the language selector you will find the “Help” item, which opens the website page with the manual, guides and demo in your browser.

For questions or support, please get in touch directly.